



the basic
argument



allowable
evils

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

In its simplest form the problem is this : God is omnipotent ; God is wholly good ; and yet evil exists. There seems to be some contradiction between these three propositions, so that if any two of them were true the third would be false. But at the same time all three are essential parts of most theological positions : the theologian, it seems, at once *must* adhere and *cannot consistently* adhere to all three.

What we need to understand, first, is why Mackie thinks that these three claims are contradictory. The three claims are:

God is omnipotent.

God is wholly good.

Some evil exists.

Now, it is certainly not obvious that these three claims are contradictory. Mackie thinks that we can show them to be contradictory with the help of two further premises:

If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much evil as it can.

If something is omnipotent,
it can do anything.



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God is omnipotent.

God is wholly good.

So the environment is.

premises:

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If something is widely

good, it always reminds

as niches in air.



If something is on it,

it can do anything.

There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.



any possible

cairibiriing about

2: If something

is important, it



the 1990s, the number of people with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems. The Department of Health (2000) has set out a vision for the future of mental health care, which includes a commitment to 'improving the lives of people with mental health problems'. This vision is based on the principles of recovery, which focuses on the individual's strengths and abilities, rather than on their diagnosis. Recovery is a process, and it is not always linear. It is a journey that involves working with the individual to develop a plan that meets their needs and goals.

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(3,6)

2. If something is on it,

3. If God exists, then God can

wholly good.

1. If God exists, then God is

it can do anything.

4. If God exists, then God is

do anything. (1,2)

elinitatesas much printless

it always initiates as much

prints evidence in it can.

6. If God exists, then God

5*. If something is wholly good,

7. If God exists, then God

evil as God said. (4,5)

8. If God exists, then there is

9*. Some principles exist.

elinitates all points less vi1.

no point less evi1. (7)



C. God does not exist. (8,9)



the basic
argument



**allowable
evils**

A large orange circle with a slight drop shadow, containing the text "what is omnipotence?".

what is
omnipotence?



the
argument
reformulated

So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



as in the visit card.

good, it always reminds

5. If something is wholly



**allowable
evils**



9*. Some points less

evivivis. exis. stis.

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "what is omnipotence?" is written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

what is
omnipotence?





If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much evil as it can.



If something is omnipotent,
it can do anything.

God is omnipotent.

God is wholly good.

somevixists.